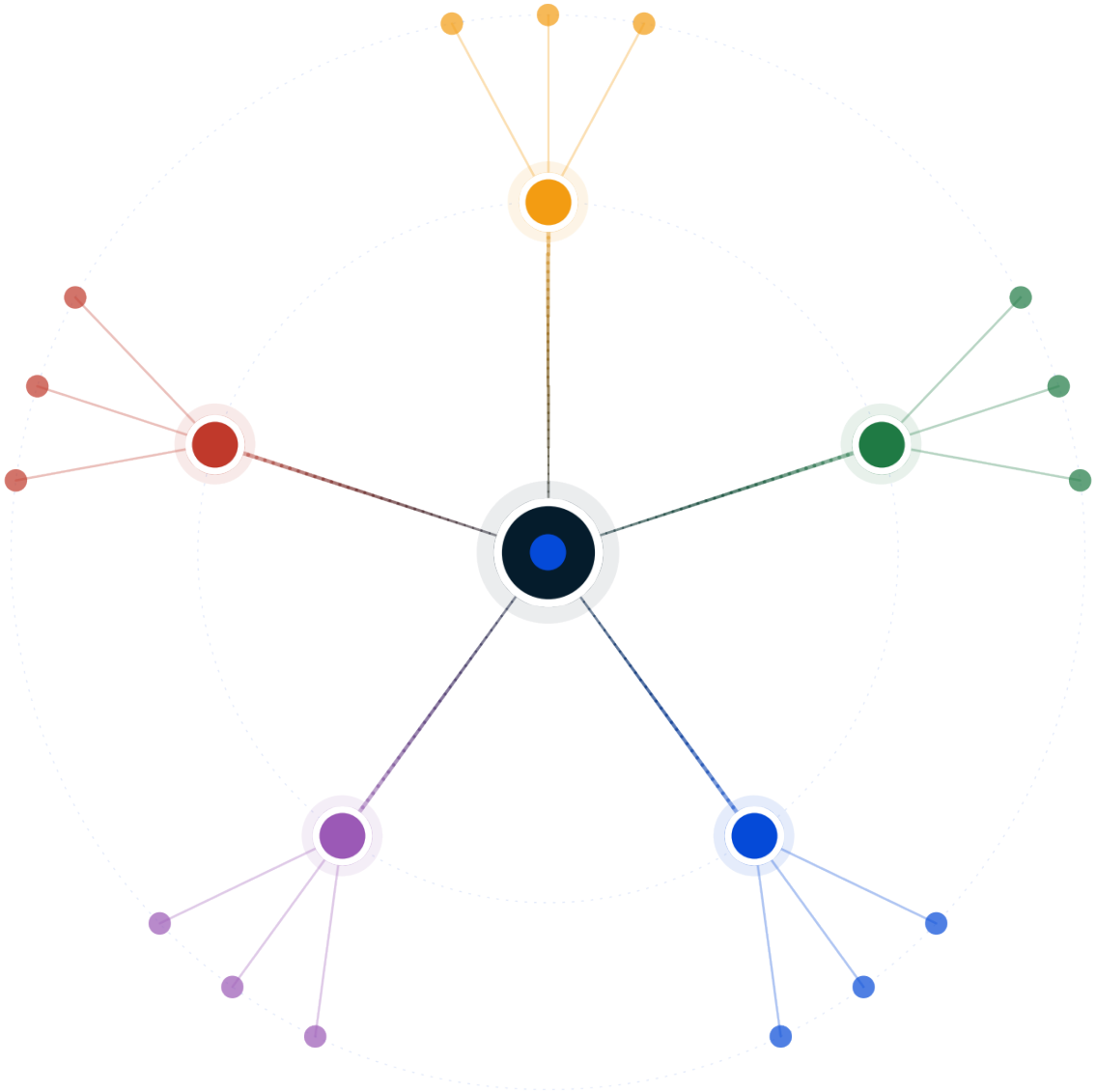
Autodecision

Should I drop B2B SaaS pricing by 30%?



Quick Decision Brief — single-pass analysis, no council

April 2026

GENERATED BY AUTODECISION — possibility map with synthesized recommendation, not a single-shot answer

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Do not implement a blanket 30% cut; the math is brutally unfavorable in a market raising prices 8-25%

DO NOT cut blanket pricing 30%. You need 43% volume lift to break even (B2B sales cycles make this near-impossible in 12 months) [G1] · LTV drops 30%+ [G2] · 2026 market is RAISING prices 8-25% [G3] — your cut reads as desperation. Existing customers (P=0.80) demand retroactive pricing, anchor permanently resets (P=0.80). Instead: (a) lower-cost SMB-only

CONFIDENCE

LOW-MEDIUM · single pass, no adversarial pressure · run / autodecision for full council on a high-stakes pricing call of this magnitude

DEPENDS ON

43% volume lift achievable in 12 months [G1] · Brand survives 30% cut in 8-25% raising market [G3] · Existing customers don't demand retroactive pricing · Competitors don't escalate to price war · LTV holds despite 30% ARPU reduction

MONITOR

ARPU on new deals · Existing customer renewal renegotiation rate · Competitor pricing pages and announcements · Enterprise vs SMB acquisition mix · Net revenue retention · Fundraising market reception

PRE-MORTEM

43% volume lift fails in 12 months (P=0.75) · Margin compresses 10-20 points (P=0.90) · Existing customers demand retroactive pricing (P=0.80) · LTV drops 30%+ (P=0.80) · Price anchor permanently resets (P=0.80)

DOMINANT RISK

No B2B SaaS precedent of a large price reduction succeeding [G9]. Industry playbook is raise / restructure / tier — never cut. A 30% cut against an 8-25% raising market signals distress to enterprise buyers AND investors.

BETTER ALTERNATIVE

Restructure to hybrid / usage-based — Chargebee data [G6] shows 38% higher revenue growth premium · Captures price-sensitive demand without permanent anchor reset · Already proven across 43% of SaaS

Source: Quick Decision Brief (single-pass) · [G1], [G2], [G3], [G6], [G9]

PART 2

How we explored this decision

Quick-mode single-pass against grounded data — what did the analysis surface?

Quick-mode single-pass with 5 hypotheses, 15 effects, 6 sensitivity assumptions — all 3 HIGH are FRAGILE

- Mode: Quick (single-pass, no council, no iteration, no adversarial pressure) — fast sanity check before a real decision, not a final answer
- 5 hypotheses generated — including 'restructure to hybrid' which scored highest, and 'cut works IF paired with model restructure' which is the only narrow-win condition
- 15 effects mapped (8 first-order + 7 second-order) with probability + timeframe per effect
- 6 key assumptions ranked by sensitivity — 3 HIGH (all FRAGILE per single-pass adversary), 2 MEDIUM, 1 LOW
- Real-world anchors: 43% volume needed to break even at 30% cut [G1] · LTV drops 30%+ on discounting research [G2] · 2026 market raising 8-25% [G3] · No B2B SaaS precedent of large reduction succeeding [G9]
- Confidence is bounded LOW-MEDIUM by design — 30% is a major pricing change; do not act on this alone, run /autodecision for full council + iteration

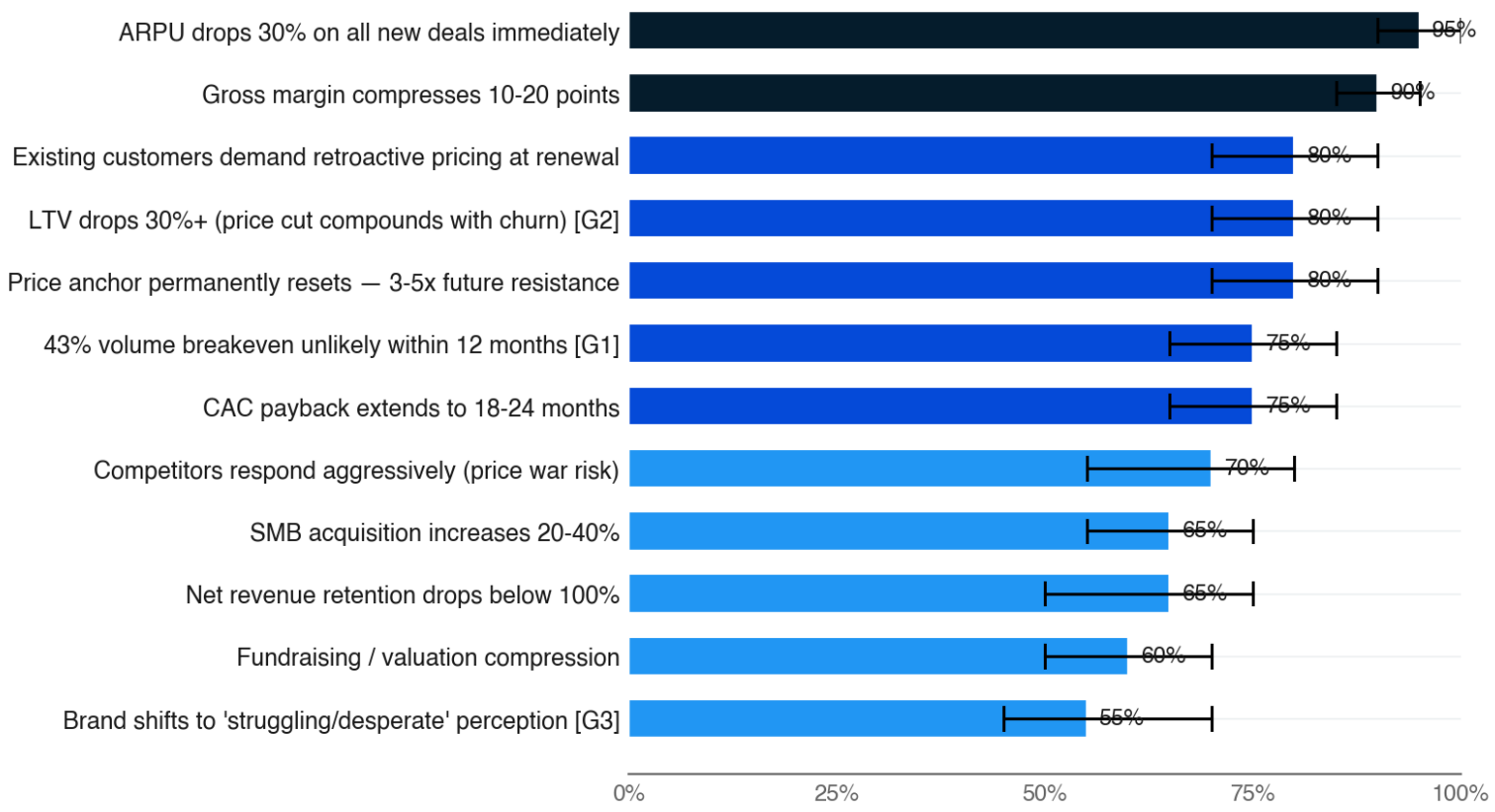
Source: Quick Decision Brief — Effects + Key Assumptions

Five hypotheses; only restructure-to-hybrid avoids permanent anchor reset

#	Hypothesis	Status	Why
1	30% cut drives 43%+ volume increase	Extremely unlikely	B2B sales cycles 3-9 months · 43% lift in <12mo near-impossible
2	30% cut wins deals but destroys margins	Pyrrhic victory	CAC payback 18-24mo · LTV -30%+ · multiples compress
3	30% cut signals desperation	Likely	Cutting in 8-25% raising market reads as distress to buyers + investors
4	30% cut works IF paired with model restructure	Narrow win condition	Only if entry tier in land-and-expand, not a cut to existing price
5	Restructure to hybrid / usage-based instead	Recommended	+38% revenue growth premium [G6] · captures demand without anchor reset

Source: Quick Decision Brief — Hypotheses

Strongest signals: ARPU collapse, margin compression, anchor reset — all near-certain



- Top 12 effects ranked by probability × agreement (single-pass: agreement is heuristic)
- Bar color = agreement weight (navy = strong evidence, fading to pale = single-source)
- Black bracket = uncertainty range
- Five effects at P>=0.80 — the cost side is near-certain, the upside (volume lift) is materially less certain
- Anchor reset (P=0.80) is the long-term scar — future increases face 3-5x resistance regardless of how the 30% cut performs short-term

Source: Quick Decision Brief — Effects (first + second order) · [G1], [G2], [G3]

Selected sources

Tags appear inline throughout the deck — [G#] = ground data (synthesized from Data Foundation table; quick-mode briefs predate ## Sources schema)

Tag	Type	Claim	Source
G1	Ground	Breakeven volume increase needed at 30% cut — 43% more customers (1/0.7)	Basic math
G2	Ground	LTV impact of SaaS discounting — lowers LTV by over 30%	SBI State of B2B SaaS Pricing 2024, T2D3
G3	Ground	Industry price direction 2026 — average 8-12% increases; aggressive movers 15-25%	Visdum, Ibbaka 2026 predictions
G4	Ground	Churn spike from pricing changes — 10-15% without legacy customer protection	Ibbaka, Visdum research
G5	Ground	Enterprise vs SMB price sensitivity — enterprise 3x less price-sensitive	Monetizely elasticity research
G6	Ground	Hybrid pricing revenue premium — 38% higher revenue growth vs single-model	Chargebee State of Subscriptions 2025
G7	Ground	B2B SaaS market 2026 — mid-cap stocks lost 30%+ in Feb 2026 SaaSpocalypse	Financial media
G8	Ground	Churn revenue impact — all-time high, 30% above COVID boom peak	SaaStr, industry benchmarks
G9	Ground	No B2B SaaS precedent of a large price reduction succeeding — playbook is raise/restructure/tier	Monetizely, Cobloom, multiple sources

Source: Quick Decision Brief — Data Foundation table (synthesized into [G#] tags)